

Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**

Q. Then why are you contesting from two seats? Are you worried?
KCR will never be worried. I have my own reasons that I will reveal after the election results come out.

Q. The Opposition claims there is anti-incumbency against your MLAs, who are allegedly highly corrupt and haven't performed.
There is not one case of corruption against them. No minister was dropped because of it. No wicket has fallen in the last 10 years. Land-grabbing is zero, money collection is zero. How come investors, national and international, are running to Telangana if it's a corrupt state?

Q. Why have you given tickets to most sitting MLAs?
I did not change MLAs in 2018 either because most of them were part of our agitation. I know their level of commitment. When there is pro-incumbency, why should I change my MLAs?

Q. You are said to have a very centralised style of leadership where all power vests with you. Is it a fair assessment?
It is very fair to me because, in certain, not all, aspects, centralisation is needed. KCR certainly decides on key issues because, as a founder of Telangana, I know the requirements of the state, and some people may not like that. But with my cabinet, we have very lengthy discussions before we deliver decisions. It functions in a highly democratic manner.

Q. As the founding father of Telangana, how have you effected the transformation you had outlined in the past 10 years?
Before being the founder, I was a fighter for the state. We were planning Telangana's trajectory even during the agitation. The state was suffering from many problems—no power, no water for drinking or for irrigation and farmers committing suicides. So, we had brainstorming sessions with top